

Food Packaging and Food-Contact Materials · BIS Standards Guide (Sample)

1. SCOPE OF THIS GUIDE

This guide summarises how Indian Standards relate to packaging that touches food: plastics, glass, metal containers and paper or board, together with labelling and marking expectations. It is a training aid, not an official BIS publication.

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2. PLASTIC PACKAGING AND FOOD CONTACT

Materials intended for contact with foodstuffs are addressed by IS 9833 (Positive List of Plastics and Materials in Contact with Foodstuffs) and related specifications for polyethylene, polypropylene, PET and polystyrene containers. The positive-list approach means only listed polymers and additives may be used. Consumers should look for a food-grade or food-safe declaration and use the container only for the temperature range stated by the maker.

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3. GLASS, METAL AND PAPER PACKAGING

Glass containers for food products are covered by Indian Standards for glass tumbler and bottle requirements; metal containers for processed food (cans) have specifications covering lacquer/coating inside the can; paper and board for food packaging (cartons, paper cups) have specifications covering food-contact quality. The key consumer check is that the package is intact, clean and declared suitable for food contact by the manufacturer.

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4. LABELLING AND MARKING ON PACKAGES

Packaged food labels must declare the product name, ingredients in descending order, net quantity, lot or batch number, manufacturing date, best-before or use-by date, storage instructions, the FSSAI licence number and the veg or non-veg symbol as applicable. Where a product carries BIS certification, the ISI mark and licence number also appear on the package. Legal metrology rules require the maker or packer name and the net quantity declaration to be prominent.

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5. WHAT CONSUMERS SHOULD CHECK

Before buying packaged food: check the seal integrity, the best-before date, the batch number, the storage conditions and, where BIS certification applies, the ISI mark with the CM/L licence number. For reusable containers at home, avoid heating food in containers not declared microwave-safe, and retire scratched or discoloured plastic containers.